

PassportSahayak AI

Knowledge Base Document

Official Operations — Counter, SLA & CCTNS

Counter Flow, Queue Management, SLA Monitoring, PV Classification & Escalation Routing

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1. Purpose & Scope

This document is the operational handbook for PSK front-desk counter officials, RPO back-office staff, and Police Verification Cell staff. It covers counter flow standards, queue management, SLA monitoring and breach escalation, category-wise annexure verification checklists, and the CCTNS dispatch and reporting workflow.

AUDIENCE: This document is intended exclusively for Official (PSK/RPO) actors. Sensitive operational parameters should not be shared with applicants beyond what is required for the applicant's own case.

2. End-to-End Process Flow

The complete passport issuance process flow from category selection through passport dispatch:

Phase	Activity	Responsible	Key Reference
Phase 1: Pre-Application	Category selection, document preparation, fee payment, appointment booking	Applicant	KB-PASS-001, KB-PASS-002
Phase 2: PSK Visit	Token (A) → Doc Verification (B) → Data Verify (C) → Biometrics (D) → Supervisor (E) → Exit	PSK Official	KB-PASS-004, Sec 3
Phase 3: RPO Processing	Application data review; PV type determination; CCTNS dispatch	RPO Official	KB-PASS-003, KB-PASS-006
Phase 4: Police Verification	Home visit, report compilation, SP countersignature, CCTNS submission	Police / PV Cell	KB-PASS-003
Phase 5: Passport Printing	RPO approves; printed at India Security Press, Nashik	RPO / ISP	Internal SOP
Phase 6: Dispatch	Speed Post dispatch; tracking number shared with applicant via SMS	India Post	KB-PASS-004
Phase 7: Grievance / Appeal	SLA breach, rejection appeal, re-verification — routed per KB-PASS-005	RPO Grievance Cell	KB-PASS-005

3. PSK Counter Operations

3.1 Counter Flow & Duration Benchmarks

Counter	Activity	Benchmark	Common Issues
Token (A)	Appointment verification; token issuance	3–5 min	Expired appointment letters; wrong PSK centre
Doc Verification (B)	Check originals vs application; collect self-attested copies	15–20 min	Missing annexures; address mismatch; photo issues
Data Verification (C)	Cross-check application data on screen with applicant	8–10 min	DOB errors; name spelling discrepancies
Biometrics (D)	Photo capture; fingerprints (4+4+2 thumbs); signature	8–12 min	Dry/scarred fingerprints (see Sec 3.3 override)
Supervisor (E)	Final check; stamp documents; issue receipt; inform of PV type and timeline	5–8 min	Tatkal eligibility disputes; missing sponsor letters

3.2 Category-wise Annexure Verification Checklist

Counter officials must verify that the correct annexures are present for the application category before proceeding to Data Verification (C).

Application Type	Mandatory Annexures	Optional / Conditional Annexures
Fresh — Adult	None mandatory	Annexure B (DOB proof issue); Annexure A (name change)
Fresh — Minor (both parents present)	Annexure D (non-applicant parent declaration)	Annexure I (if birth cert unavailable)
Fresh — Minor (one parent present)	Annexure C + Annexure D	Annexure H (single parent); Annexure I
Re-issue — Name change (marriage)	Marriage certificate	Annexure E (if name change not in gazette)
Re-issue — Lost passport	FIR copy + Notarised affidavit	—
Tatkal application	Supporting urgency document	Annexure E (if urgency not otherwise documented)
Government employee	Annexure F (employer certificate)	Annexure G (for armed forces)
Date of birth correction	Annexure B + birth certificate	Affidavit + 2 corroborating documents
ECR to ECNR upgrade	Educational certificate (10th pass or above)	Professional certificate if applicable

3.3 Biometric Override Procedures

Scenario	Procedure
Dry/rough fingerprints	Re-attempt after moistening; if fail: Supervisor authorises manual exception with photograph
Injured finger	Capture available fingers; annotate system with injury note; medical certificate if permanent
Amputation / disability	Capture available biometrics; supervisor approves exception; annotated in system for RPO awareness
Photograph rejection	Re-capture at biometric station; up to 3 attempts; beyond 3: Supervisor review
Child below 5 years	Fingerprints waived; photograph and parent signature captured; re-biometric on renewal

4. Queue Management & Slot Capacity

4.1 Daily Slot Allocation

Slot Type	Typical Allocation	Notes
Normal — Morning Session (9 AM – 1 PM)	60–70% of daily capacity	Standard queue; pre-booked only
Normal — Afternoon Session (1 PM – 5 PM)	20–25% of daily capacity	Standard queue; pre-booked only
Tatkal	10–15% of daily capacity	Separate queue; priority processing
POPSK Walk-in (select centres)	5–10% of daily capacity	Limited service only; no fresh applications at most POPSKs

Officials may use AppointmentBookingTool to query current-day slot utilisation and remaining capacity for queue management decisions.

5. SLA Monitoring & Breach Escalation

SLA Metric	Target	Monitoring	Action on Breach
PSK visit completion	< 90 min per applicant	Daily	PSK Manager review; additional staff deployment

SLA Metric	Target	Monitoring	Action on Breach
PV request dispatch	Within 3 working days of PSK visit	Daily	RPO Supervisor alert; immediate dispatch
PV completion by police	30 working days	Weekly (Days 15, 25)	CCTNS reminder Day 15; SP escalation Day 25
Passport dispatch (Normal)	30 working days from PV clearance	Weekly	RPO Grievance Cell alert; expedite print order
Passport dispatch (Tatkal)	3 working days from PSK visit	Daily	RPO Duty Officer alert; same-day resolution
Grievance resolution	7–15 working days	Daily	Grievance cell supervisor alert; EscalationTool invoked
Application on-hold resolution	30 calendar days	Weekly	EscalationTool invoked; applicant notified via SMS

SLA BREACH RULE: Any SLA breach not resolved within 24 hours of detection must be routed via EscalationTool to the RPO Grievance Cell supervisor with full case context. The Citizens' Charter mandates public quarterly SLA compliance reporting.

6. Inter-state PV Coordination for Officials

When an applicant's registered address falls outside the RPO's jurisdiction, the following CCTNS routing procedure applies:

Scenario	Official Action
Applicant address in another state / RPO jurisdiction	Generate CCTNS request to SP of applicant's registered district; track via CCTNS inter-state queue
Applicant relocated recently (within 12 months)	Dual-address PV: requests generated for both current and previous address SP offices; 45-day extended SLA
Address in CCTNS-uncovered area	Manual PV request via official letter to SP; acknowledge 45-day extended SLA in applicant communication
Conflict between current and permanent address	Prioritise current (registered) address for PV; note permanent address in CCTNS remarks field
PV from another state — delayed beyond 45 days	Escalate via CCTNS to DGP office of the respective state; RPO records escalation in system

7. Document Control

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